

# **Search Strategy and Source Quality Criteria**

## **1. Introduction**

For our project, we are working with Thuiszorg Totaal. We are researching how AI could support the company, mainly with scheduling and notifications.

To research this properly, we need reliable sources. Our platform should help us search for information, evaluate the quality of sources and decide which sources are suitable for our research.

This document explains our search strategy, selection criteria and source quality criteria.

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## **2. Search Strategy**

In our blueprint, the Retrieve stage is responsible for finding additional sources. It searches in both English and Dutch.

We will use different search terms connected to our project.

### **English searches**

- AI scheduling in home care
- AI scheduling in healthcare
- Automated employee scheduling healthcare
- Automatic notifications in home care
- AI automation for healthcare SMEs
- AI scheduling Netherlands
- AI scheduling and GDPR

### **Dutch searches**

- AI personeelsplanning in de thuiszorg
- Automatische personeelsplanning in de zorg
- AI voor thuiszorgorganisaties
- Automatische meldingen in de thuiszorg
- AI planning in de Nederlandse zorg

- AI en AVG in de zorg

Searching in Dutch is important because it can help us find information specifically about the Dutch healthcare sector, Dutch home-care organizations, Dutch regulations and local examples that may not appear when searching only in English.

The Retrieve stage adds the sources it finds to the platform so they can later be evaluated.

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### **3. Finding Real Examples**

We do not want our research to depend only on companies selling AI or scheduling software.

Our search should actively try to find at least one documented example of a comparable healthcare or home-care provider using a similar scheduling or notification system.

For example, if a software company says:

"Our AI scheduling system saves healthcare organizations time."

We should search for evidence from an organization that actually used the system.

The research should therefore not be considered complete if we only find vendor claims.

If no comparable case can be found, we should clearly mention this limitation in our research instead of presenting the vendor claim as proven.

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### **4. Source Selection Criteria**

Before scoring a source, the Appraise stage should first check whether the source is suitable.

**Include a source when:**

- It is relevant to our research.
- The author or organization can be identified.
- The original information can be checked.
- It provides useful information or evidence.
- It is recent enough for the topic.
- It is relevant to healthcare, home care, SMEs or the Netherlands/Europe.

### Exclude a source when:

- It is not relevant.
- The author or organization cannot be identified.
- The original information cannot be found.
- It makes important claims without evidence.
- It is outdated for the topic.
- It is mainly advertising a product without supporting evidence.

Vendor sources can still be useful for understanding what a product does, but they should not be used alone as evidence that the product is effective.

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## 5. Source Quality Criteria

Sources that pass the first selection should be evaluated in the Appraise stage.

We will use five criteria.

| Criterion          | What we check                                                                                    | Points     |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>Relevance</b>   | Does it directly relate to AI, scheduling, notifications or home care?                           | 25         |
| <b>Reliability</b> | Can we identify the author/publisher, their expertise, and the type of organization/publication? | 20         |
| <b>Evidence</b>    | Does it provide research, data, references or a documented case?                                 | 30         |
| <b>Recency</b>     | Is the information recent enough for the topic?                                                  | 10         |
| <b>Context</b>     | Is it relevant to healthcare, home care, SMEs, Netherlands or Europe?                            | 15         |
| <b>Total</b>       |                                                                                                  | <b>100</b> |

### Making Reliability Measurable

Instead of simply asking whether an organization is "trustworthy," we check specific things:

- Is the author or publisher clearly identified?
- Does the author or organization have relevant expertise?

- Is it a government, academic, healthcare, research, professional or commercial source?
- Can we verify the original publication?

This makes it easier for different team members to evaluate the same source in a similar way.

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## 6. Evidence Is a Minimum Requirement

Evidence is especially important for our research.

A source must receive at least 15 out of 30 points for Evidence before it can be classified as a good or very good source.

This prevents a vendor page from receiving a high overall score simply because it is highly relevant and comes from a well-known company.

For example, a vendor could receive:

Relevance: 25/25

Reliability: 18/20

Evidence: 8/30

Recency: 10/10

Context: 15/15

**Total: 76/100**

Even though the total score is relatively high, the source does not pass because its Evidence score is below 15.

It could still be used to explain the vendor's product, but not as evidence that the product actually works.

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## 7. Final Source Score

Sources that meet the minimum Evidence requirement can then be classified using their total score:

**80–100 = Very good source**

**60–79 = Good source**

**40–59 = Weak source**

**Below 40 = Do not use**

However, the score supports our decision; it does not replace human judgement.

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## **8. Where This Happens in Our Blueprint**

Our process should match the stages already defined in our technical blueprint.

### **Retrieve**

**Searches for sources in Dutch and English.**

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### **Appraise**

**Evaluates individual sources.**

This is where we apply:

- Inclusion/exclusion criteria
- The 0–100 source score
- The minimum Evidence requirement
- Keep/discard decision

The appraisal file should therefore contain the source score together with a short explanation of why the source received that score.

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### **Draft**

Only the selected/appraised sources are used to create the chapter.

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### **Check**

**Check does NOT score individual sources.**

Check happens later. It checks the finished chapter against our six handbook quality criteria:

- Clear

- Practical
- Easy to understand
- Evidence-based
- Responsible
- Actionable

Therefore, **Appraise checks sources, while Check checks the final draft.**

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## 9. Complete Process

Our source research process is:

**Retrieve → Appraise → Draft → Check**

**Retrieve:** Find information in Dutch and English.

**Appraise:** Evaluate and score each source.

**Draft:** Use the approved sources to create the handbook chapter.

**Check:** Evaluate the finished chapter against the six quality criteria.

A human team member should still review important decisions because the AI platform can make mistakes.

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## 10. Conclusion

For our Thuiszorg Totaal project, we need reliable information about using AI for scheduling and notifications.

Our platform will search in Dutch and English and will actively look for real examples from comparable healthcare organizations instead of depending only on vendor claims.

Individual sources will be evaluated during the Appraise stage using relevance, reliability, evidence, recency and context.

Evidence has a minimum requirement, which prevents a source with weak evidence from receiving a high rating simply because it scores well in other areas.

This creates a clear process:

**Retrieve → Appraise → Draft → Check**

This also keeps the source evaluation consistent with the structure of our technical blueprint.